

# THE LEGACY OF REV. HENRY MORONFOLU GBAYO

Founder, Celestial Church of Christ Gbayo Parish, Ikorodu

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"Remember them which have the rule over you, who have spoken unto you the word of God: whose faith follow, considering the end of their conversation." — Hebrews 13:7

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### A Life Ordained by God

The story of **Celestial Church of Christ Gbayo Parish, Ikorodu**, cannot be told without first telling the story of the man through whom God birthed the vision—**Reverend Henry Moronfolu Gbayo**.

Born on **7 July 1945**, Reverend Henry Moronfolu Gbayo lived a life characterized by excellence, faith, humility, and unwavering obedience to God. He departed this earthly realm on **28 November 2007**, leaving behind a legacy that continues to inspire generations of worshippers.

Long before he became a revered spiritual leader, Rev. Gbayo distinguished himself professionally. He travelled to Europe to further develop his knowledge and capabilities and subsequently returned to Nigeria, where he rose to become the **Managing Director of Midland Leather**.

At the time, he was a devoted member of the Baptist Church and served faithfully as a deacon. By all appearances, his future seemed clearly mapped out. Yet God had prepared a different assignment for him—one that would impact countless lives.

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### Divine Steps into the Celestial Fold

God often leads His servants through unexpected paths.

Rev. Gbayo married **Mrs. S.O. Gbayo**, a committed member of the Celestial Church of Christ. Around this same period, discussions arose within the Baptist Church regarding the remarkable growth and influence of the Celestial Church.

Seeking answers, Rev. Gbayo volunteered to investigate firsthand.

In \*\*1977\*\*, he attended a service at \*\*Celestial Church of Christ Itire Parish\*\*, unaware that this visit would permanently alter the course of his life.

Standing quietly at the back of the church during worship, he observed the proceedings with the curiosity of a sincere seeker. Suddenly, the Holy Spirit moved through a prophet and delivered an extraordinary message.

The prophet walked directly to him and requested the presence of the shepherd. Under divine instruction, the shepherd was told to bring Rev. Gbayo into the altar and unveil its sacred contents so he could understand what the Celestial Church truly represented.

What began as an investigation became a divine encounter.

That very day, Rev. Gbayo stepped into the altar—not merely as a visitor, but as a man being called into God's purpose.

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## Learning Faith Through Divine Healing

Not long after joining the Celestial Church, Rev. Gbayo faced a severe health challenge.

Medical specialists recommended surgery and considered it the only viable solution. However, during worship, God spoke through prophetic revelation, instructing him not to undergo any operation. Instead, he was directed to continue using sanctification water and to remain steadfast in faith.

As time passed, the condition appeared to worsen, and he was eventually rushed to hospital.

Despite the urgency of the situation, Rev. Gbayo remained resolute in his conviction. He informed the doctor—who happened to be a close friend—that he did not wish to be operated upon.

Concerned for his life, the doctor assumed responsibility and proceeded with preparations for surgery.

Rev. Gbayo was sedated.

The operating theatre was ready.

Everything appeared set.

Yet when the doctor arrived and uncovered the surgical area, he discovered something astonishing: the condition that had necessitated surgery had already disappeared.

The procedure was no longer necessary.

The hospital was thrown into amazement.

Doctors, nurses, patients, and visitors became witnesses to an event they could not medically explain.

For Rev. Gbayo, it was another confirmation that faith in God is never misplaced.

As Scripture declares:

gt; \*"For with God nothing shall be impossible."\* — Luke 1:37

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## The Power of the Holy Spirit

While still recovering in the hospital, another remarkable event unfolded.

A visitor who had come to see a patient suddenly collapsed and died.

The atmosphere became chaotic as confusion spread throughout the hospital.

Why should a healthy visitor die while the patient remained alive?

As the commotion intensified, Rev. Gbayo sensed the prompting of the Holy Spirit.

Slowly rising from his hospital bed, he walked to where the lifeless man had been laid.

Placing his cross upon the man's chest, he prayed.

Moments later, the man gasped for breath and came back to life.

The entire hospital erupted in astonishment.

News spread rapidly of the Celestial member who had refused surgery, experienced miraculous healing, and then prayed for a dead man who returned to life.

For Rev. Gbayo, these events were never about personal recognition. They served as testimonies of the power and mercy of God.

Throughout his life, he consistently taught that all glory belongs to God alone.

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## Answering the Call

As the years progressed, Rev. Gbayo continued to grow spiritually within the Celestial Church.

He advanced through the various stages of ministry—from humble beginnings as a **Brother**, faithfully serving God and His people, and gradually rising through the spiritual ranks until he attained the revered office of **Reverend**.

Each elevation reflected not merely position, but demonstrated commitment, discipline, spiritual maturity, and unwavering service.

After relocating to **Iyana Ipaja**, he joined **Celestial Evangelical World Crusader (CEWC)** and continued his ministry.

Then came the defining moment.

In **1991**, God called him into full-time ministry.

The instruction was clear.

The response was immediate.

The day after receiving God's call, Rev. Gbayo resigned from his prestigious professional position and devoted himself entirely to the work of the Kingdom.

Like the disciples who left their nets to follow Christ, he chose obedience over comfort and purpose over personal ambition.

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## Shepherd of Transformation

Following his divine calling, Rev. Gbayo became shepherd of **CEWC Shyllon Parish**.

Under his leadership, the parish experienced remarkable transformation.

Members became more disciplined and spiritually grounded.

The choir flourished.

Bible knowledge increased.

Youth became actively engaged in ministry.

The congregation became known for excellence, order, and devotion.

People were not merely attending church; they were growing in Christ.

His ministry emphasized both spiritual power and spiritual responsibility.

He taught believers not only how to worship but how to live.

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## The Birth of CCC Gbayo Parish

In time, God instructed him to establish a new parish in Ikorodu.

In obedience to that divine commission, \*\*Celestial Church of Christ Gbayo Parish, Ikorodu\*\*, was founded and officially commissioned on \*\*17 March 1996\*\*.

What began as a divine instruction soon became a spiritual home for countless believers.

The church was established upon principles that remain its foundation today:

## Love

Rev. Gbayo taught that love is the greatest evidence of true Christianity.

## Truth

He believed firmly that God's people must know and live by His truth.

This conviction became embodied in the church's enduring motto:

gt; \*\*"And ye shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free."\*\*

gt;

gt; — John 8:32

## The Holy Spirit

He emphasized continual dependence upon the Holy Spirit and encouraged believers to cultivate a personal relationship with God.

He often taught that every Christian should be spiritually mature enough to hear from God through prayer, faith, and obedience, while still respecting divine authority within the church.

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## A Shepherd Who Carried People's Burdens

Perhaps Rev. Gbayo's most remarkable characteristic was his love for people.

He carried the burdens of others as though they were his own.

He rejoiced with those who rejoiced.

He wept with those who wept.

He gave generously of his time, energy, and prayers.

Broken hearts found comfort in his counsel.

Discouraged souls found hope in his words.

Countless lives found direction through his ministry.

His leadership reflected the words of Christ:

gt; \*"The good shepherd giveth his life for the sheep."\* — John 10:11

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## The Jerusalem Experience

In \*\*2002\*\*, Rev. Gbayo joined a pilgrimage to Jerusalem.

At the famous Wailing Wall, pilgrims were given the opportunity to offer personal prayers before God.

After praying earnestly, the group boarded their buses and began the journey back to Tel Aviv.

As they travelled, the Holy Spirit came upon a pastor seated in the same bus.

The pastor suddenly knelt before Rev. Gbayo and declared that God had revealed something extraordinary.

According to the revelation, Rev. Gbayo had spent his time praying for everyone else but had forgotten to pray for himself.

The entire bus was moved.

Here was a man so concerned about others that he overlooked his own needs.

The convoy turned back.

Rev. Gbayo returned to the Wailing Wall and offered his personal prayer.

The incident remains one of the clearest demonstrations of his selflessness and love.

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## His Glorious Homegoing

On \*\*28 November 2007\*\*, Rev. Henry Moronfolu Gbayo completed his earthly race and entered eternal rest.

Yet even in death, extraordinary events surrounded his departure.

The following day, as his body was being carried to the burial site, witnesses observed an unusual phenomenon.

A smoke-like formation resembling incense spiraled upward like a whirlwind.

As it ascended into the heavens, it transformed into a rainbow that remained visible for several minutes.

The rainbow then became a bright white light before disappearing into the sky with astonishing speed.

The event left many in awe.

Members of a nearby mosque reportedly emerged, glorifying God and expressing wonder at what they had witnessed.

To many present, it felt like a heavenly affirmation of a life faithfully lived.

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## The Legacy Continues

Today, nearly three decades after the establishment of the parish and many years after his passing, the vision of Rev. Henry Moronfolu Gbayo remains alive.

The church continues to stand as a beacon of faith, truth, holiness, and love.

His children and spiritual descendants have continued to serve faithfully as Levites and custodians of the vision, ensuring that the values, teachings, and spiritual heritage entrusted to him remain undiluted for future generations.

The mission remains unchanged:

- \* To proclaim Christ.
- \* To teach truth without compromise.
- \* To depend on the Holy Spirit.
- \* To love all people.
- \* To prepare souls for Heaven.

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## Our Heritage

We proudly stand upon the spiritual foundation laid through:

- \* God Almighty, the Head of the Church.
- \* The Lord Jesus Christ, our Saviour and King.

\* The Holy Spirit, our Comforter and Guide.

\* \*\*Papa Samuel Bilehou Joseph Oshoffa\*\*, Founder of the Celestial Church of Christ Worldwide.

\* \*\*Reverend Henry Moronfolu Gbayo\*\*, Founder of CCC Gbayo Parish, Ikorodu.

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## Our Declaration

\*\*Celestial Church of Christ Gbayo Parish is a Spirit-filled church where everybody is somebody and Jesus reigns supreme.\*\*

Since \*\*17 March 1996\*\*, we have remained committed to worshipping God in spirit and in truth, preserving the legacy of our founder, and preparing believers for the ultimate goal:

## HEAVEN.

"I have fought a good fight, I have finished my course, I have kept the faith." — 2 Timothy 4:7

\*\*Rev. Henry Moronfolu Gbayo (1945–2007)\*\*

\*A faithful servant, a loving shepherd, and a lasting legacy.\*